COMP 182 and COMP 182L

Data Structures and Program Design

Fall 2026 | California State University Northridge

This syllabus explains the course requirements, assessments, grading, AI-use rules, and ways to obtain support. Check Canvas regularly for assignments, deadlines, course materials, and announcements.

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Instructor and course meetings

Instructor: Bahram Zartoshty

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Instructor course website

Office: Jacaranda Hall 4442. Office hours: Monday and Wednesday, 12:45-2:15 PM.

• COMP 182 lecture, section 16588: Monday and Wednesday, 11:30 AM-12:45 PM, Jacaranda 1600.

• COMP 182L lab, section 16592: Monday and Wednesday, 2:30-3:45 PM, fully online through Zoom.

• COMP 182L lab, section 16593: Monday and Wednesday, 4:00-5:15 PM, fully online through Zoom.

• Class dates: August 24-December 11, 2026.

For both lab sections, use the Zoom meeting link and access details posted in Canvas.

Final exam

COMP 182 section 16588: date and time to be announced according to the university final exam schedule. Location: Jacaranda 1600. Exams are in person even though the lab sections meet online.

You are required to take the final exam. If an emergency prevents you from taking it, contact me as soon as possible. Missed work and any resulting grade are handled under applicable university rules and approved accommodations. A WU is appropriate only when the university criteria for unauthorized withdrawal are met, including insufficient completed work to evaluate academic performance; it is equivalent to an F in GPA calculations.

Communication and Canvas

Use email for course-related communication. Keep messages focused and begin the subject line with COMP 182 Question. Include your full name, course and section, and CSUN email address. Send messages from your CSUN account whenever possible so I can identify you.

I generally respond within 24 hours on academic days. General technical questions may be discussed during lecture, lab, or on the Canvas Q&A page so the class can benefit. Use private email for grades, accommodations, and other personal matters.

CSUN Canvas course materials and announcements

Announcements, notes, assignments, and important updates are posted on Canvas. Written Canvas announcements take precedence over conflicting informal course information. Check Canvas regularly. Changes to a policy or deadline will be communicated in writing.

Course description and learning outcomes

This course introduces data structures and the algorithms that use them. You will design, implement, and apply arrays, linked lists, stacks, queues, trees, heaps, hash tables, maps, and sets. The course also covers recursion, abstract data types, algorithm efficiency, and time-complexity analysis. You will compare sorting and searching algorithms and choose data structures for program design problems.

By the end of the course, you should be able to:

• Design and implement Java programs using the data structures specified in an assignment.

• Explain abstract data types and distinguish an interface from its implementation.

• Apply recursion and explain base cases and recursive steps.

• Trace algorithms and analyze their time complexity.

• Compare data structures and searching and sorting methods for a given problem.

• Compile, test, debug, and document programs, and explain the behavior of your submitted code.

Materials and technology

Optional textbook

No textbook is required. The recommended optional text is Y. Daniel Liang, Introduction to Java Programming and Data Structures, 10th edition, 11th edition, or later, Prentice Hall. I may refer to its material and examples during the semester.

Required equipment and software

Bring a personal laptop to lecture and have it available during online lab. The course requires a Mac or Windows laptop, a Java Development Kit (JDK), and a Java editor or IDE. jGRASP and IntelliJ IDEA are recommended options. Install software appropriate to your operating system and use the JDK version specified in the course setup instructions. Online labs also require reliable internet access and access to Zoom and Canvas.

Java Development Kit downloads

jGRASP downloads

IntelliJ IDEA downloads

If access to equipment, the internet, or required software is a barrier, contact me early to discuss available support and ways to complete the course requirements.

Participation and classroom expectations

Attendance at every lecture and your enrolled lab is required. Unannounced quizzes may be given. Arrive on time, participate in discussions, and practice the programming techniques demonstrated in class. Reading slides alone does not replace the explanations and practice provided during class. Slides and related course materials will be posted on Canvas.

Use your laptop for course activities. Mobile devices and headphones are not permitted during lecture unless I authorize their use or they support an approved accommodation. This restriction does not prohibit assistive technology. If disability-related needs or an access barrier affect attendance or participation, contact me and the relevant campus support office privately.

Assessments and submissions

Exams and quizzes

There are two exams: a midterm and a final. Each is worth 30% of the combined course grade. Exams assess lecture material, labs, assignments, projects, and class examples. They are administered in person and on paper, subject to approved accommodations.

Exams may include multiple-choice questions, short answers, code tracing, algorithm analysis, and coding questions. Exams are closed book and closed note. No AI tools, phones, smartwatches, browsers, or other aids are permitted unless explicitly authorized or provided through an approved accommodation.

Quizzes are worth 20% of the course grade. They may be given in person or as take-home work and are open book and open note. Open book and open note does not authorize AI use, collaboration, solution websites, or communication with others. Follow each quiz's written instructions.

The midterm is tentatively associated with Unit 7. Its date, the final exam date and time, and assignment deadlines will be announced on Canvas.

Projects and labs

Expect approximately four to six scheduled projects. They reinforce lecture topics and develop skills in programming, algorithms, and data structures. Labs and projects together are worth 20% of the course grade.

Projects may be completed individually or with one partner, unless an assignment specifies otherwise. Work submitted by an approved pair may contain code jointly written by those two students. Each student must understand the entire submission and submit the project through their own Canvas account.

For each project:

1. Include all group members' names in comments at the beginning of every submitted file.

2. Include all files needed to compile, run, and test the program.

3. Place the submission files in a compressed ZIP folder.

4. Name your ZIP file P##_LastName_FirstName.zip using the submitting student's name. Example: P01_Zartoshty_Bahram.zip.

5. Upload the ZIP file through Canvas and check that the correct file was submitted.

A project or program may receive zero if it does not compile without syntax errors, does not use the data structure required by the assignment, or omits files needed to compile, run, and test it. Read the assignment requirements and rubric before submitting.

Collaboration and acknowledgment

You may discuss general ideas, algorithms, and problem-solving approaches with classmates. For an authorized two-person project, collaborate only within your approved pair on the submitted implementation. For individual work, write your own code.

Do not copy another student's or an outside source's solution, share solutions beyond your approved pair, or allow someone else to submit your work. Acknowledge any sources or assistance that an assignment permits. Similarity arising from a limited number of reasonable solutions will be considered, but you remain responsible for understanding your work.

Deadlines and unexpected barriers

Every project and assignment has a due date. Late work is not accepted except as required by approved accommodations or applicable university requirements. If an emergency or an access problem prevents timely completion or submission, contact me as soon as possible to discuss the situation. An email by itself does not grant an extension or replace a Canvas submission unless I authorize that arrangement.

Generative AI and independent work

Generative AI is prohibited on all graded work unless I explicitly authorize it in writing for a specific assignment. This rule covers projects, labs, quizzes, exams, code, test cases, algorithm analyses, explanations, and documentation. It applies to chatbots, AI code completion, code generation, AI debugging, and AI rewriting, including features integrated into an IDE.

What the rule means

• Do not ask AI to solve, outline, complete, debug, translate, or rewrite any part of a graded task unless the assignment explicitly permits it.

• Do not put assignment prompts, starter code, quizzes, exam questions, or graded-work code into an AI tool without explicit permission.

• Do not submit AI-generated code, pseudocode, tests, analysis, or prose as your own work. Disclosure does not make prohibited assistance permissible.

• Disable generative AI features while completing graded work. Ordinary non-generative tools such as syntax highlighting, compilation, and standard debugging remain permitted unless an assessment says otherwise.

• You may use AI for ungraded study of general concepts or unrelated practice problems. Keep this separate from graded tasks and verify explanations against course materials.

If an assignment permits AI

Follow the assignment's written limits. Disclose the tool and model if available, the date, your prompts, and how you used the output. Include the relevant interaction or excerpt as directed. Explain what you tested, corrected, and verified. You must be able to explain every submitted algorithm and line of code. You remain responsible for accuracy and appropriate acknowledgment.

Example disclosure for an authorized activity: I used [tool and model] on [date] with the prompt [prompt]. I used the output to [purpose], verified it by [tests or course references], and changed [specific changes].

Privacy and assistive technology

Do not upload grades, passwords, personal information, another student's work, or materials you lack permission to share. No paid AI subscription is required. If an authorized activity requires an AI tool that you cannot access or use, contact me before the deadline to arrange an equivalent way to meet the learning goal.

Screen readers, speech input, and other assistive technologies are not prohibited. If an assistive tool also generates answers or code, discuss that function privately with me and DRES or NCOD so approved accommodations can be implemented clearly. Ask before using an uncertain tool or feature on graded work.

Grading

You will receive one combined grade for COMP 182 and COMP 182L.

Category	Weight
Midterm exam	30%
Final exam	30%
Quizzes	20%
Labs and projects	20%
Total	100%

The overall percentage is 0.30 times the midterm percentage, plus 0.30 times the final exam percentage, plus 0.20 times the quiz percentage, plus 0.20 times the lab and project percentage. Consult Canvas and each assignment's rubric for points and assessment details.

Letter grades

Plus/minus grading is used. Each threshold below is a minimum percentage. The highest letter grade whose minimum is met will be assigned; for example, 92.8% is A- and 93.0% is A.

Minimum percentage	Letter grade
93	A
90	A-
87	B+
83	B
80	B-
77	C+
73	C
70	C-

Minimum percentage	Letter grade
67	D+
63	D
60	D-
0	F

Academic integrity

Academic integrity requires honest work, fair assessment, and respect for others' contributions. Academic dishonesty includes plagiarism, cheating, and fraud.

Plagiarism

Do not present someone else's work as your own or use it without appropriate acknowledgment. Unauthorized AI-generated material is prohibited. Do not resubmit work from another course without my knowledge and approval. Permission to work in a pair applies only to the assignment and pair authorized for that work.

Cheating and fraud

• Do not copy quiz or exam answers or use unauthorized materials, tools, collaboration, or communication during an assessment.

• Do not use AI, solution sites, or outside services to complete graded work unless explicitly authorized.

• Do not upload, download, share, duplicate, or obtain restricted course or assessment materials without permission.

• Do not have someone else complete an assessment, misrepresent your identity or participation, falsify records or supporting documents, or submit a false medical note.

• Do not buy, sell, steal, or improperly obtain exams, or improperly access or obstruct course systems.

Academic dishonesty may result in zero on an assignment or examination, a failing course grade, and referral to the appropriate university student conduct office. Suspected violations and any disciplinary action are subject to university procedures.

CSUN Student Conduct resources

Accessibility and student support

Requesting accommodations

Students who need disability-related accommodations should register with Disability Resources and Educational Services (DRES) or NCOD Deaf and Hard of Hearing Services, as appropriate. Use the Student Access and Accommodation System (SAAS) to request and manage approved accommodations for each term and course.

DRES: Bayramian Hall 110; 818-677-2684; dres@csun.edu.

NCOD Deaf and Hard of Hearing Services: Jeanne Chisholm Hall; 818-677-2054; ncod@csun.edu.

DRES accommodation procedures

SAAS accommodation and testing information

NCOD Deaf and Hard of Hearing Services

Contact me privately to discuss implementation of approved accommodations, including exam arrangements, participation, assistive technology, and deadlines as applicable. Request testing arrangements early using the relevant office's current procedures. If an accommodation is not working, notify me and DRES or NCOD promptly. You do not need to send medical documentation or diagnostic details to me by email.

Accessible course materials and online labs

I will work with the appropriate campus offices to address access barriers in course materials, online labs, required tools, and assessments. If a file, video, diagram, platform, or IDE is inaccessible, contact me with the material's title or link, the barrier, and any time-sensitive deadline. You may request accessible text, captions, descriptions of diagrams, or another appropriate format.

For online labs, let me know if captions, keyboard access, screen sharing, or displayed code creates a barrier. Approved communication access services and assistive technology apply to online participation as appropriate. An access problem should be addressed promptly rather than left until the assessment deadline.

In your own documentation, use headings, clear labels, and selectable text. Submit source files rather than replacing code with screenshots. Provide a text explanation for diagrams and describe errors in words. Ask for an accessible submission method if the required workflow creates a disability-related barrier.

Course accessibility academic and student support guide

Changes to the syllabus

Changes may be necessary. I will announce changes in class and through Canvas, and revised syllabi will carry a revision date. Changes to AI permissions will be communicated in writing before they apply to affected work. Students are responsible for reviewing course announcements.

Tentative course outline

The order and pace may change. Units indicate a sequence of topics rather than fixed calendar weeks. Refer to Canvas for assignment deadlines and exam announcements.

Unit	Topics
1	COMP 110 review and arrays
2	Objects and classes
3	Inheritance polymorphism and exception handling
4	Abstraction and recursion
5	Abstract data types ArrayList and LinkedList
6	Algorithm efficiency

Unit	Topics
7	Review and midterm exam
8	Stacks and queues
9	Binary trees
10	Heaps and priority queues
11	Hashing
12	Maps and sets

University policy resources

CSUN AI course policy and Withdrawal Unauthorized policy

CSUN syllabus requirements